Claude Code Cheat Sheet

Claude Code v2.1.87
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KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

General Controls

- `Ctrl` `C` Cancel input/generation
- `Ctrl` `D` Exit session
- `Ctrl` `L` Clear screen
- `Ctrl` `O` Toggle verbose/transcript
- `Ctrl` `R` Reverse search history
- `Ctrl` `G` Open prompt in editor
- `Ctrl` `X` `Ctrl` `E` Open in editor (alias)
- `Ctrl` `B` Background running task
- `Ctrl` `T` Toggle task list
- `Ctrl` `V` Paste image ([Image #N] chip)
- `Ctrl` `X` `Ctrl` `K` Kill background agents
- `Esc` `Esc` Rewind or summarize

Mode Switching

- `Shift` `Tab` Cycle permission modes
- `Alt` `P` Switch model
- `Alt` `T` Toggle thinking
- `Alt` `O` Toggle fast mode

Input

- `\` `Enter` Newline (quick)
- `Ctrl` `J` Newline (control seq)

Prefixes

- `/` Slash command
- `!` Direct bash
- `@` File mention + autocomplete

Session Picker

- `↑↓` Navigate
- `←→` Expand/collapse
- `P` Preview
- `R` Rename
- `/` Search
- `A` All projects
- `B` Current branch

Transcript Mode (Ctrl+O)

- `/` Search transcript
- `N` / `Shift` `N` Next/prev match
- `Ctrl` `E` Toggle show all
- `Q` / `Esc` Exit transcript

MCP SERVERS

Add Servers

- `--transport http` Remote HTTP (recommended)
- `--transport stdio` Local process
- `--transport sse` Remote SSE

Scopes

- `Local` ~/.claude.json (you only)
- `Project` .mcp.json (shared/VCS)
- `User` ~/.claude.json (global)

Manage

- `/mcp` Interactive UI
- `claude mcp list` List all servers
- `claude mcp serve` CC as MCP server
- `Elicitation` Servers request input mid-task
- `2KB cap` Tool desc + server instructions limit

SLASH COMMANDS

Session

- `/clear` Clear conversation
- `/compact [focus]` Compact context
- `/resume` Resume/switch session
- `/rename [name]` Name current session
- `/branch [name]` Branch conversation (/fork alias)
- `/cost` Token usage stats
- `/context` Visualize context (grid)
- `/diff` Interactive diff viewer
- `/copy [N]` Copy last (or Nth) response
- `/rewind` Rewind conv / code checkpoint
- `/export` Export conversation

Config

- `/config` Open settings
- `/model [model]` Switch model (←→ effort)
- `/fast [on|off]` Toggle fast mode
- `/vim` Toggle vim mode
- `/theme` Change color theme
- `/permissions` View/update permissions
- `/effort [level]` Set effort (low/medium/high/max/auto)
- `/color [color]` Set prompt-bar color
- `/keybindings` Customize keyboard shortcuts
- `/terminal-setup` Configure terminal keybindings

Tools

- `/init` Create CLAUDE.md
- `/memory` Edit CLAUDE.md files
- `/mcp` Manage MCP servers
- `/hooks` Manage hooks
- `/skills` List available skills
- `/agents` Manage agents
- `/chrome` Chrome integration
- `/reload-plugins` Hot-reload plugins
- `/add-dir <path>` Add working directory

Special

- `/btw <question>` Side question (no context)
- `/plan [desc]` Plan mode (+ auto-start)
- `/loop [interval]` Schedule recurring task
- `/voice` Push-to-talk voice (20 langs)
- `/doctor` Diagnose installation
- `/pr-comments [PR]` Fetch GitHub PR comments
- `/stats` Usage streaks & prefs
- `/insights` Analyze sessions report
- `/desktop` Continue in Desktop app
- `/remote-control` Bridge to claude.ai/code (/rc)
- `/usage` Plan limits & rate status
- `/schedule` Cloud scheduled tasks
- `/security-review` Security analysis of changes
- `/help` Show help + commands
- `/feedback` Submit feedback (alias: /bug)
- `/release-notes` View full changelog
- `/stickers` Order stickers! 🎉

MEMORY & FILES

CLAUDE.md Locations

- `./CLAUDE.md` Project (team-shared)
- `~/.claude/CLAUDE.md` Personal (all projects)
- `/etc/claude-code/` Managed (org-wide)

Rules & Import

- `.claude/rules/*.md` Project rules
- `~/.claude/rules/*.md` User rules
- `paths: frontmatter` Path-specific rules
- `@path/to/file` Import in CLAUDE.md

Auto Memory

- `~/.claude/projects/<proj>/memory/`
  MEMORY.md + topic files, auto-loaded (25KB/200 lines max)

WORKFLOWS & TIPS

Plan Mode

- `Shift` `Tab` Normal → Auto-Accept → Plan
- `--permission-mode plan` Start in plan mode

Thinking & Effort

- `Alt` `T` Toggle thinking on/off
- `"ultrathink"` Max effort for turn
- `Ctrl` `O` See thinking (verbose)
- `/effort` ○ low · ◐ medium · ● high · ★ max

Git Worktrees

- `--worktree name` Isolated branch per feature
- `isolation: worktree` Agent in own worktree
- `sparsePaths` Checkout only needed dirs
- `/batch` Auto-creates worktrees

Voice Mode

- `/voice` Enable push-to-talk
- `Space` `(hold)` Record, release to send
- `20 languages` EN, ES, FR, DE, CZ, PL...

Context Management

- `/context` Usage + optimization tips
- `/compact [focus]` Compress with focus
- `Auto-compact` ~95% capacity
- `1M context` Opus 4.6 (Max/Team/Ent)
- `CLAUDE.md` Survives compaction!

Session Power Moves

- `claude -c` Continue last conv
- `claude -r "name"` Resume by name
- `/btw question` Side Q, no context cost

SDK / Headless

- `claude -p "query"` Non-interactive
- `--output-format json` Structured output
- `--max-budget-usd 5` Cost cap
- `cat file | claude -p` Pipe input

Scheduling & Remote

- `/loop 5m msg` Recurring task
- `/rc` Remote control
- `--remote` Web session on claude.ai

CONFIG & ENV

Config Files

- `~/.claude/settings.json` User settings
- `.claude/settings.json` Project (shared)
- `.claude/settings.local.json` Local only
- `~/.claude.json` OAuth, MCP, state
- `.mcp.json` Project MCP servers
- `managed-settings.d/` Drop-in policy fragments

Key Settings

- `modelOverrides` Map model picker → custom IDs
- `autoMemoryDirectory` Custom memory dir
- `worktree.sparsePaths` Sparse checkout dirs
- `sandbox.failIfUnavailable` Exit if sandbox fails
- `hooks: if` Conditional hooks (permission rule syntax)
- `allowedChannelPlugins` Admin channel plugin allowlist

Key Env Vars

- `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`
- `ANTHROPIC_MODEL`
- `CLAUDE_CODE_EFFORT_LEVEL` low/medium/high/max/auto
- `MAX_THINKING_TOKENS` 0=off
- `ANTHROPIC_CUSTOM_MODEL_OPTION` Custom /model entry
- `CLAUDE_CODE_PLUGIN_SEED_DIR` Multiple plugin seed dirs
- `CLAUDE_CODE_SUBPROCESS_ENV_SCRUB` Strip creds from subprocs
- `CLAUDE_STREAM_IDLE_TIMEOUT_MS` Streaming watchdog (def 90s)
- `CLAUDECODE` Detect CC shell (=1)

SKILLS & AGENTS

Built-in Skills

- `/simplify` Code review (3 parallel agents)
- `/batch` Large parallel changes (5-30 worktrees)
- `/debug [desc]` Troubleshoot from debug log
- `/loop [interval]` Recurring scheduled task
- `/claude-api` Load API + SDK reference

Custom Skill Locations

- `.claude/skills/<name>/` Project skills
- `~/.claude/skills/<name>/` Personal skills

Skill Frontmatter

- `description` Auto-invocation trigger
- `allowed-tools` Skip permission prompts
- `model` Override model for skill
- `effort` Override effort level
- `paths: [globs]` Path-specific (YAML list)
- `context: fork` Run in subagent
- `$ARGUMENTS` User input placeholder
- `${CLAUDE_SKILL_DIR}` Skill's own directory
- `!`cmd` Dynamic context injection

Built-in Agents

- `Explore` Fast read-only (Haiku)
- `Plan` Research for plan mode
- `General` Full tools, complex tasks
- `Bash` Terminal separate context

Agent Frontmatter

- `permissionMode` default/acceptEdits/plan/dontAsk/bypass
- `isolation: worktree` Run in git worktree
- `memory: user|project` Persistent memory
- `background: true` Background task
- `maxTurns` Limit agentic turns
- `initialPrompt` Auto-submit first turn
- `SendMessage` Resume agents (replaces resume)

CLI & FLAGS

Core Commands

- `claude` Interactive
- `claude "q"` With prompt
- `claude -p "q"` Headless
- `claude -c` Continue last
- `claude -r "n"` Resume
- `claude update` Update

Key Flags

- `--model` Set model
- `-w` Git worktree
- `-n / --name` Session name
- `--add-dir` Add dir
- `--agent` Use agent
- `--allowedTools` Pre-approve
- `--output-format` json/stream
- `--json-schema` Structured
- `--max-turns` Limit turns
- `--max-budget-usd` Cost cap
- `--console` Auth via Anthropic Console
- `--verbose` Verbose
- `--bare` Minimal headless (no hooks/LSP)
- `--channels` Permission relay / MCP push
- `--remote` Web session
- `--effort` low/medium/high/max/auto
- `--permission-mode` plan/default/...
- `--dangerously-skip-permissions` Skip all prompts ⚠️
- `--chrome` Chrome
- `PowerShell tool` Windows opt-in preview

Permission Modes: `default` · `acceptEdits` · `plan` · `dontAsk` · `bypassPermissions` · `--dangerously-skip-permissions`

Key Env Vars: `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` · `ANTHROPIC_MODEL` · `CLAUDE_CODE_EFFORT_LEVEL` · `MAX_THINKING_TOKENS` · `CLAUDE_CODE_MAX_OUTPUT_TOKENS` · `CLAUDE_CODE_DISABLE_CRON` · `CLAUDE_CODE_SUBPROCESS_ENV_SCRUB`